

What's new in Windows 10 for developers

>>What isn't new in Windows 10 would probably make for a shorter article, but that isn't the title is it? > by **Kshitij Sobti**

With Windows 10, some of the biggest changes coming to Windows don't even have to do with its features and functionality, but on how those are delivered. Windows is moving towards Windows-as-a-Service, and this might just have a huge impact on how software targeting Windows is developed and delivered in the future.

The first impact is that Windows once installed on a device will continue to update to the latest version of Windows for the rest of the life of that device. For those running Home versions of Windows 10, these updates are even automatic and mandatory. Even for 'Pro' users the only control they have is to switch to a slower release cycle and even that should update every 8 months or so.

Combine that with a free upgrade to Windows 10 for any computer running Windows 7 and above – which is any computer from the past five years. For a software developer this means that targeting the latest version of Windows (and only the latest version of Windows) is now a whole lot more feasible. Currently targeting Windows can be somewhat of a mess. If you want to reach all Windows users, you

need to target Windows XP, Windows 7 and Windows 8.1. However, these three operating systems couldn't differ more in their design sensibilities. Windows XP with its blue bubbly UI, Windows 7 and its glassy aero look and Windows 8.x's 'Modern' UI.

With Windows constantly updated with new features, and no major releases every few years for users to pay for and install, developers can more reasonably expect the majority market share to be at the release. Will things really work out as well? Only time will tell, but there is more reason to expect this than there was before.

The changes under the hood are as no less massive. There are sweeping changes to Windows as a platform that can really simplify developing Windows apps and that is the new Windows Core.

Windows Core

Windows Core is Microsoft essentially realising that they own the most popular operating system in the world, and that they should probably use it in more places. In the past Microsoft's different platforms have had rather different APIs and even different kernels.

*Open Source



*IBM open sources 30 projects, plans 50

>>The open source projects cover a vast domain over Analytics, Cloud IoT, Mobile, Security, Social, Watson and others.

<http://dgit.in/IBMOpenSrc>



*Open source project discovery using Sinder

>>Sinder is a simple open source project discovery tool that links to your Github account, so that you can choose the right project.

<http://dgit.in/SinderApp>



*NSA released its Linux-based InfoSec tool

>>Releasing one of their cyber security tools, the NSA wants government departments and private sector to beef up their security.

<http://dgit.in/NSAInfoSec>